E.H. CARR AND REALISM

The efforts of the liberals to establish a peaceful world order through international organizations, disarmament, open diplomacy, self-determination and other lofty ideals were vehemently criticized by Carr[11] (1939) in his polemical work *Twenty Years' Crisis: 1919–1939*. He was of the opinion that "The teleological aspect of the science of international politics has been conspicuous from the outset. It arose from a great disastrous war; the overwhelming purpose which dominated and inspired the pioneers of the new science was to obviate a recurrence of this disease of the international body politic". Therefore, it was the passionate desire to prevent war that determined the direction of the study. The obvious outcome was that international politics came to be marked by utopianism. The liberal doctrine of harmony of interest seems to be untenable because in reality whatever common interests are present, are "nothing more than an expression of the satisfied powers with a vested interest in the preservation of the status quo". Actually, the doctrine of harmony of interests, according to Carr, serves as an ingenious moral device invoked in perfect sincerity by privileged groups in order to justify and maintain their position. The crux of the matter is that what seems to be absolute universal principles are nothing but the unconscious reflections of national policy based on a particular interpretation of national interest at a particular time. They are nothing but transparent disguises of selfish vested interests. He opines that "The inner meaning of the modern international crisis is the collapse of the whole structure of utopianism based on the concept of harmony of interest". The bankruptcy of utopianism resides, according to Carr, not in its failure to live up to its principles but in the exposure of its inability to provide any absolute and disinterested standard for the conduct of international affairs. Therefore, the importance of power politics has to be acknowledged in international relations. But Carr suggested that to get sound political theories, both elements of utopianism and realism, namely, power and moral values are required.